28 Careers in IT

Before you start

1 **Work in pairs and discuss the questions.**

1 What are your plans when you finish school?
2 Do you want to use, or think you will need to use, IT in your job?
3 Make a list of jobs which use IT.

Reading

2 **Read the quotes and write the name of the students by the jobs they want.**

1 Web designer Peter
2 Computer programmer Elissa
3 Database administrator Martin
4 E-commerce manager Katie

Elissa

"I'm interested in writing software. My friends say I'm a techno-nerd because I prefer working with computers to people. Money is important but I'd rather do a job I enjoy. I want to take a distance-learning course so I can study at home."

Katie

"I like shopping and I think the future of business is on the Internet. I'm good with computers but I also like working with people. I'd like to manage my own online company. This will give me a lot of responsibility. E-commerce comes with risks, but the rewards are high when you succeed."

Martin

"Many people like Web design, but I think data management gives more job security. There is so much information on the Internet, and companies need people who know how to store, manage and retrieve data. I want to get my degree and work for a good company."

Peter

"I'm using JavaScript to make my website more interactive. After college, I'd like to try telecommuting. This is working at home, using e-mail to communicate with clients. I want freedom, flexibility and long holidays, which you don't get by working in an office."

3 **Write E, K, M or P. Which student:**

1 wants to work at home? P
2 wants a secure job? M
3 does not want to study in college? E
4 wants to choose when to work? P
5 wants to manage people? K
6 likes working with data? M
7 wants to be rich and successful? K
8 uses a coding system for web pages? P

Vocabulary

4 **Underline the ways of expressing *like* or *want* in the quotes, then choose the correct answer.**

1 _____ telecommuting to working in an office.
a I'd rather **b** I prefer **c** I like

2 _____ to do a distance-learning course.
a I'd prefer **b** I'd rather **c** I don't like

3 _____ working long hours all the time.
a I'd prefer **b** I don't like **c** It's good

4 _____ to work with computers all day as I think it would be boring.
a I'd rather not **b** I wouldn't like **c** I don't like

5 _____ be a rich techno-nerd than poor and popular.
a I'd rather **b** I prefer **c** I like

6 _____ in being a secretary. I want a better job.
a I'm not interested **b** I'm thinking of **c** I don't like

Speaking

5 **Work in groups. Rank the things you want from a job: 1 = most important, 10 = least important.**

a high salary ■ flexible working hours
■ responsibility ■ interest or enjoyment
■ a nice office ■ telecommuting
■ long holidays ■ working with people
■ security ■ excitement/risk
■ good benefits, e.g. a company car, gym membership

Writing

6 **Write a paragraph to say what kind of job you would like, and why.**

I'm really keen on cybersecurity. Specifically, I'd love to work as a penetration tester. It's all about finding vulnerabilities in systems and networks by simulating cyber attacks. I find it thrilling to stay on top of emerging threats while actively contributing to strengthening cybersecurity defenses.